

WEeping FIG

Ficus benjamina

The weeping fig is probably one of the most recognizable houseplants. The flexibility, beauty, and air-cleansing properties of this plant make it a surefire life enhancer, while the delicate, glossy, oval leaves create a striking indoor feature.

“I’m a statuesque plant that’s a great air purifier.”

Help me thrive



POSITION

This plant needs a minimum temperature of 50°F (10°C) and to be placed where it will get indirect sunlight.



POTTING

Grow in a nutrient-rich loam-based potting mix, adding fine bark chippings to aid drainage.



GROWTH RATE

Can reach 10ft (3m) tall by 6½ft (2m) wide, growing moderately fast, and can be pruned to remove dead material or to reshape and control.



CARE

Don’t overwater. Keep the soil moist when in growth, and water more sparingly in winter. Give it a high-nitrogen fertilizer every 4 weeks.



I’ll clean your air

My leaves can help reduce the risk of nose, mouth, and throat irritation caused by breathing in formaldehyde which comes from synthetic fabrics and xylene which can cause dizziness, headaches, and confusion, coming from paint, rubber, and printing.



Be mindful of me

My leaves can fall if I suffer from a lack of food or light or if I’m left for a long time without water. When young I can be repotted every year to accommodate my growing roots, but when I’m mature, I’ll be happy staying in the same pot.

